

Two Days

If I knew I only had two days with you

I'd take your hand
and we'd
run
to
the
water.

We'd peel off our clothes
and wade in
to face the current.

We'd turn again
to face each other
and
your breath
would
be
a
warm
wind
against
my throat.

I'd heat
oil
between my
palms

let
it
drip
into
your
bath

We'd climb in
sit
knee to knee.
I'd memorize the lines
around the corners of your eyes
a map
to the place where
the water gathers.

We'd stand
still
in the ocean
feet
sinking
deeper
into
the
sand
as
each
wave
came
for us.

Your tears would dry in the sun.

I'd lick the salt
from your lips.

I'd feed you an
olive
then
crush the rest
in my fist.

A tiny rivulet of brine
streams down my forearm,
burning.

By Abby Buchanan (2025)